

Weekly Microcycle (U19)

Objective of the week

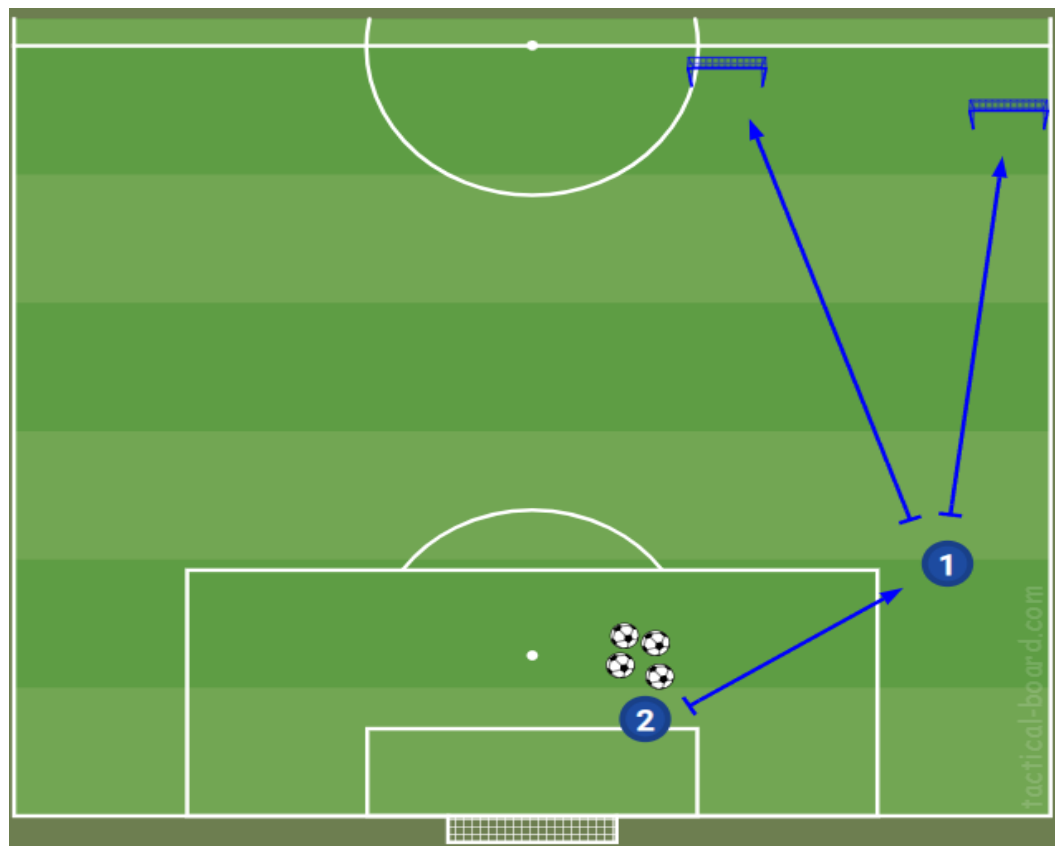
To improve full-backs' ability to **progress the ball forward**, integrated within the team training process without overloading the weekly structure.

Day	Match Relation	Time	Training Type	Content
Monday	MD-5	10:15 – 12:30	Collective training	T
Monday	MD-5	12:45 – 13:00	Individual training	Full-backs: body orientation & forward passing (no pressure)
Tuesday	MD-4	—	OFF	Recovery
Wednesday	MD-3	10:15 – 12:30	Collective training (PSS + SSP)	Full-back progression integrated into team training
Thursday	MD-2	10:15 – 12:30	Collective training	Tactical preparation + wide progression
Thursday	MD-2	12:45 – 13:00	Individual training	Reinforcement of key behaviours (low intensity)
Friday	MD-1	10:15 – 12:30	Collective training	Pre-match activation
Saturday	MD	12:00 – 14:00	Match	League match
Sunday	MD+1	—	OFF / Recovery	Regeneration

MD-5 – Individual Training

Title

Full-Back Forward Reception and Passing Through Gates



Objective

To improve full-backs' ability to receive with an open body orientation and play forward passes after receiving from the centre-back.

Organization

- Players: 1 full-back, 1 server (coach acting as CB)
- Equipment: balls, 2–3 small goals (gates)
- Area: a **flank area**

Description

- The coach (acting as centre-back) passes the ball to the full-back.
- The full-back must adjust their body orientation before receiving.
- After the first touch forward, the player must pass the ball into one of the small goals.
- The coach calls out a number (e.g., 1 or 2) before or during the pass, indicating which goal the player must target.

Progression / Variation

- Add a scoring system between players (competition).

Coaching Points

- scanning before receiving
- open body position
- first touch forward
- quick decision making
- accuracy of forward pass

Why this exercise is used

This exercise introduces the key behaviour of **playing forward instead of backwards** in a controlled environment without pressure. It prepares full-backs for more complex decision-making situations later in the week.



MD-5 – Individual Training (Progression)

Title

Full-Back Forward Reception with Dribbling and Decision Making

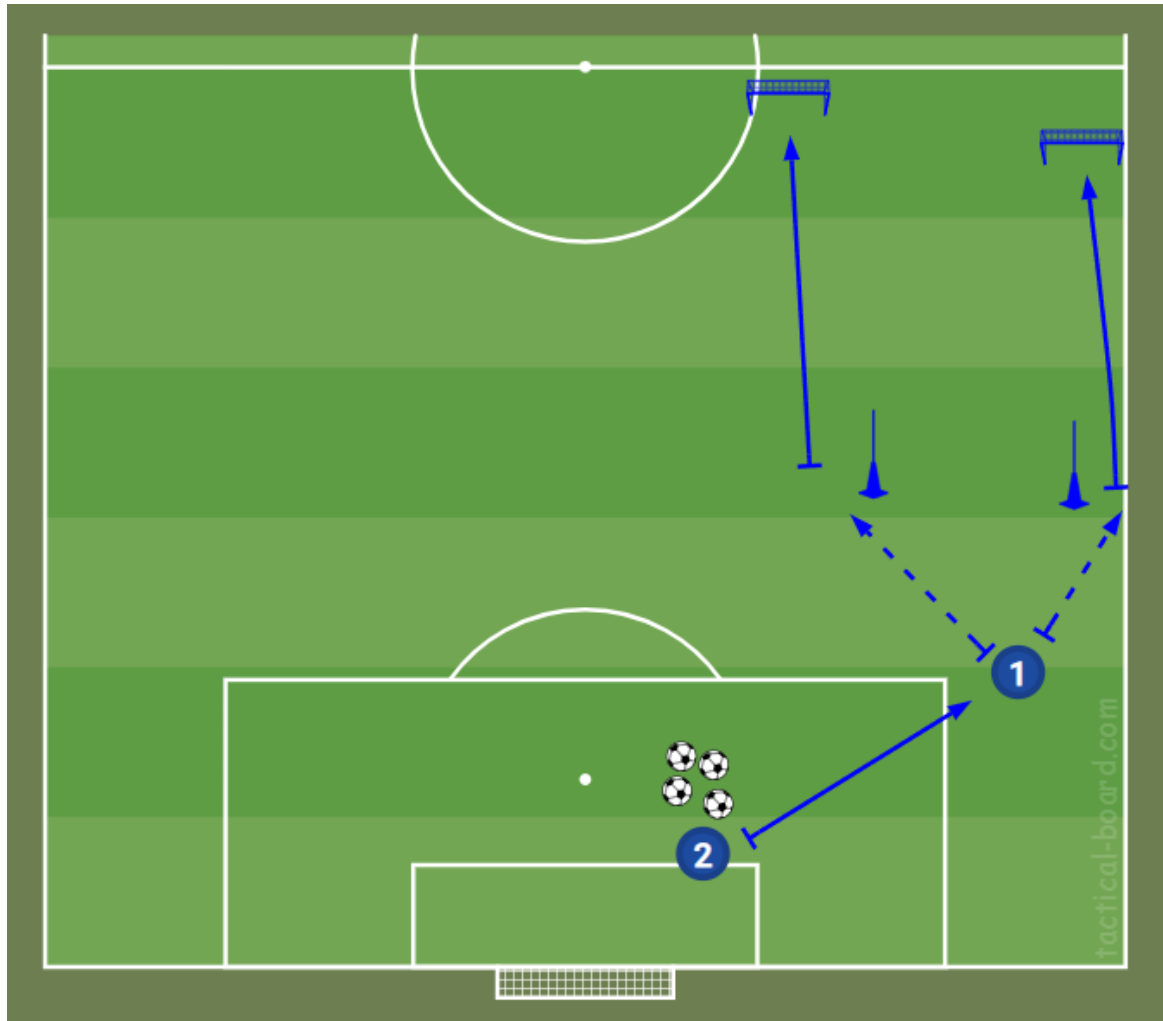
Objective

To develop full-backs' ability to receive, carry the ball forward, and choose the correct passing option based on external cues.

Organization

- Players: 1 full-back, 1 coach (server)
- Equipment: balls, 2–3 small goals, 2 cones (left/right)
- Area: a **flank area**

Diagram



Description

- The coach passes the ball to the full-back.
- Before or during the pass, the coach calls out two numbers (e.g., “1–2”).

Meaning:

- First number → direction of dribble (cone 1 or 2)
- Second number → target goal (gate 1 or 2)

Sequence

1. Full-back receives the ball with an open body orientation
2. First touch into space (left or right depending on call)
3. Dribble towards the selected cone
4. Pass the ball into the correct goal

Key Behaviour

The player is encouraged to:

- attack space after receiving
- avoid playing backwards
- recognize when to carry the ball forward

Coaching Points

- scanning before receiving
- explosive first touch into space
- correct dribbling direction
- decision making based on cues
- quality of final pass

MD-5 – Functional Practice

Title

Switch of Play and Wide Attack with Finishing

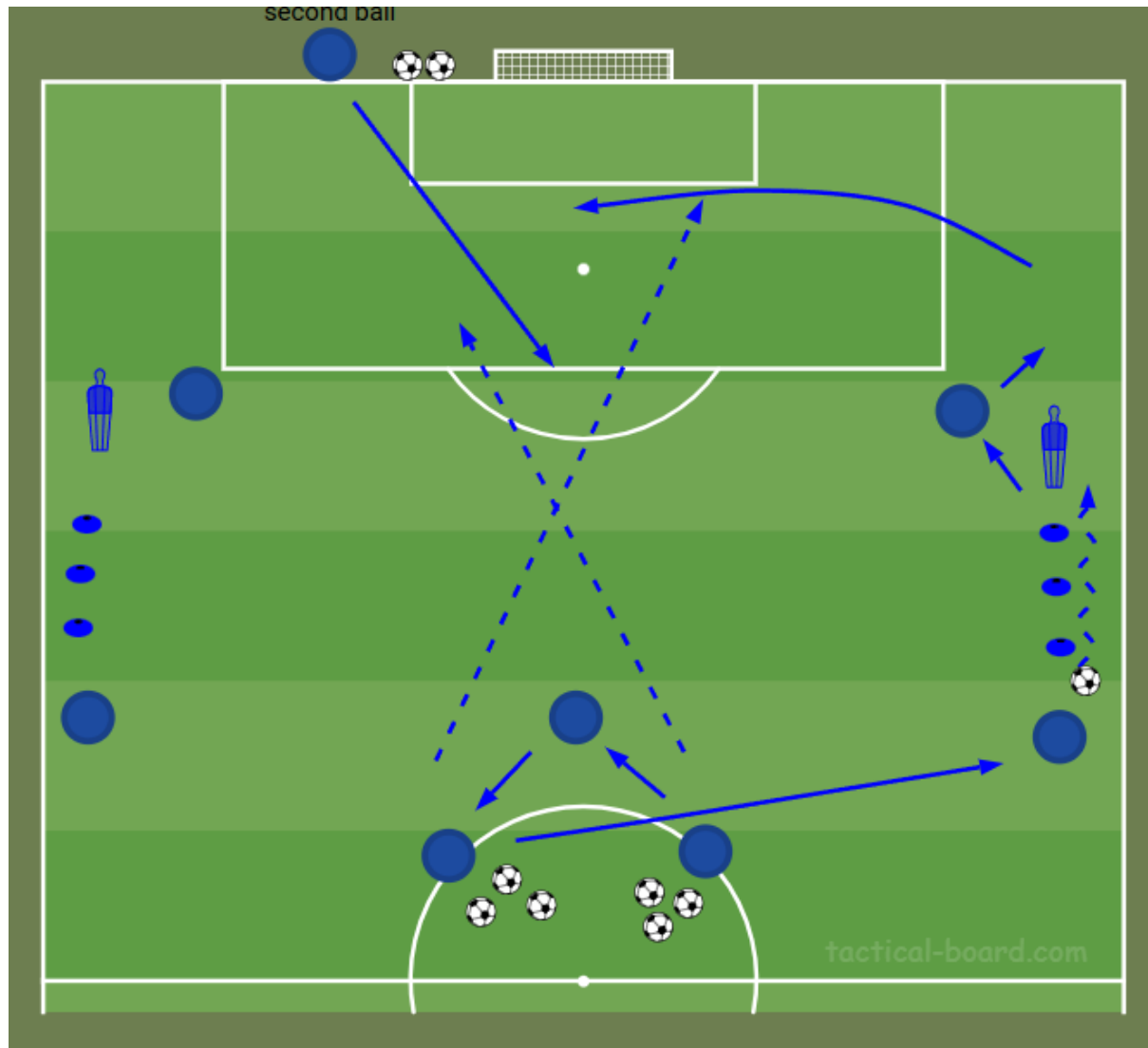
Objective

To develop full-backs' involvement in wide progression, crossing, and attacking contribution in the final third.

Organization

- Players:
 - Central players (CM / CB / ST)
 - Full-backs (wide players)
 - Wingers
 - 2 finishing players
- Area:
Half pitch, including wide channels and penalty area
- Equipment: balls, cones, mannequins, full-size goal

Diagram



Description

1. The exercise starts in the central area with a pass combination.
2. The ball is played to a central player, who switches play to the opposite flank.
3. The full-back receives the ball in the wide channel.
4. The full-back combines with the winger (e.g., overlap or one-two).
5. After beating the mannequins, the full-back delivers a cross into the penalty area.

Finishing Phase

- Two attacking players make **opposite (crossing) runs**:
 - one attacks near post
 - one attacks far post
- Timing of runs is crucial.

Second Ball

- After the cross and finish, the coach serves a second ball (rebound situation).
- The second player must finish quickly (1–2 touches).

Coaching Points

- timing of runs in the box
- quality and type of cross
- body orientation of full-back
- decision making (when to cross vs combine)
- speed of reaction for second ball

Why this exercise is used

This exercise links the role of the full-back in **build-up and wide progression** with their contribution in the final third. It also develops finishing and reaction to second balls.

MD-3 – Position-Specific Situation (PSS)

Title

Full-Back Progression Through the Pressing Line

Objective

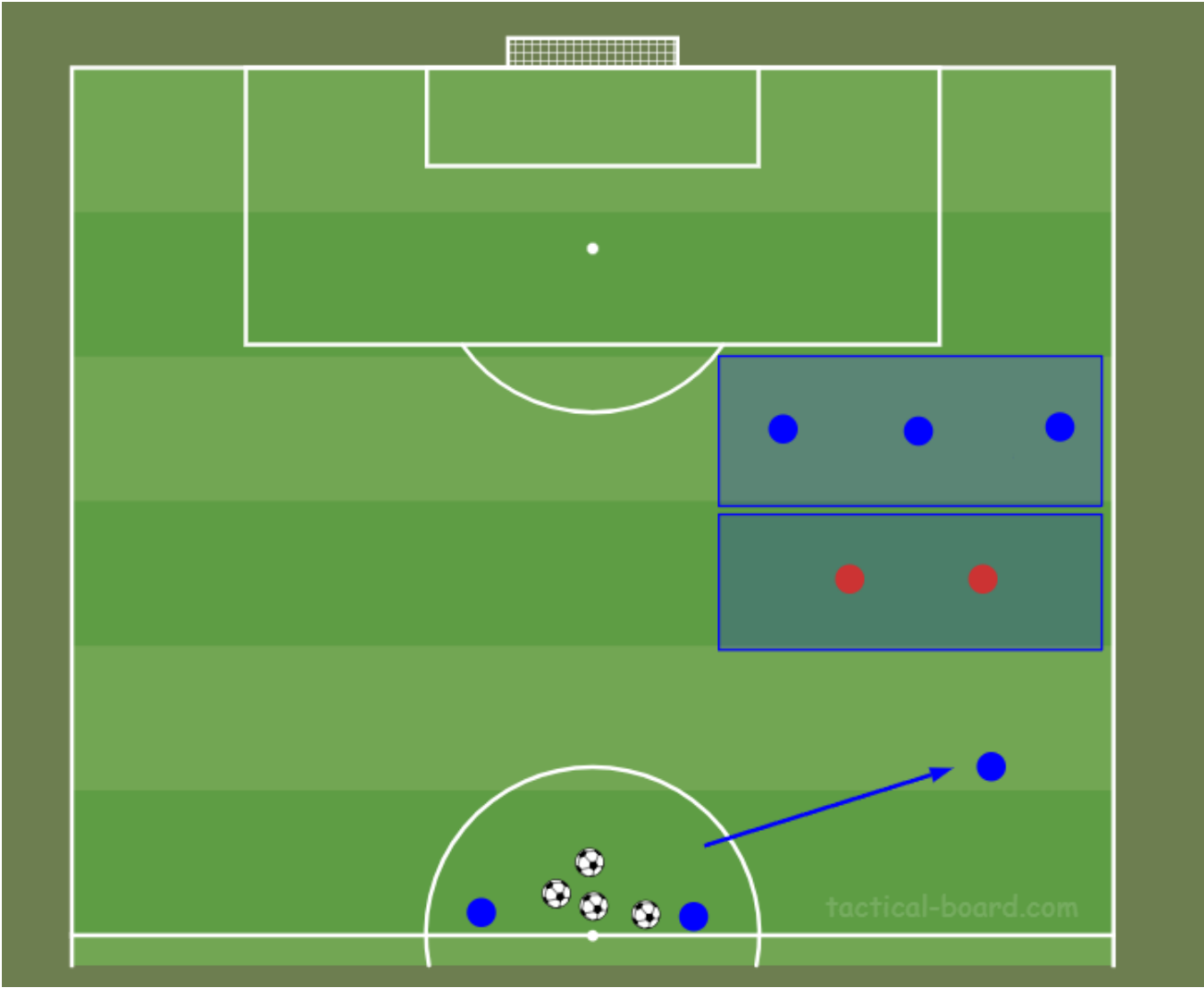
To improve full-backs' ability to break the opposition's first pressing line and find forward passing options under time and touch constraints.

Organization

- Players:
 - 1 Centre-back (server)
 - 1 Full-back
 - 2 defenders (pressing line)
 - 3 attacking players (between lines)
- Area:

Wide channel on the flank, divided into zones (defensive third → midfield zone)

Diagram



Description

- The exercise starts with a pass from the centre-back to the full-back.
- The full-back receives the ball under pressure from two defenders forming a pressing line.
- The objective is to **play a forward pass through the pressing line** to one of the three attacking players positioned between the lines.

Constraints

- Maximum **2 touches** (control + pass)
- Limited time to act (e.g., 3–4 seconds)
- Backward pass is not allowed

Scoring System

- 1 point for each successful forward pass breaking the line
- Bonus point for correct decision (free player found)

Coaching Points

- scanning before receiving

- body orientation (open to the field)
- quick decision making
- recognition of free player between lines
- passing accuracy under pressure

Why this exercise is used

This exercise recreates a realistic build-up scenario where the full-back must make quick decisions under pressure and find forward passing options instead of playing backwards.

MD-3 – Small-Sided Practice (SSP)

Title

Wide 2v2 + Neutral Game for Full-Back Progression

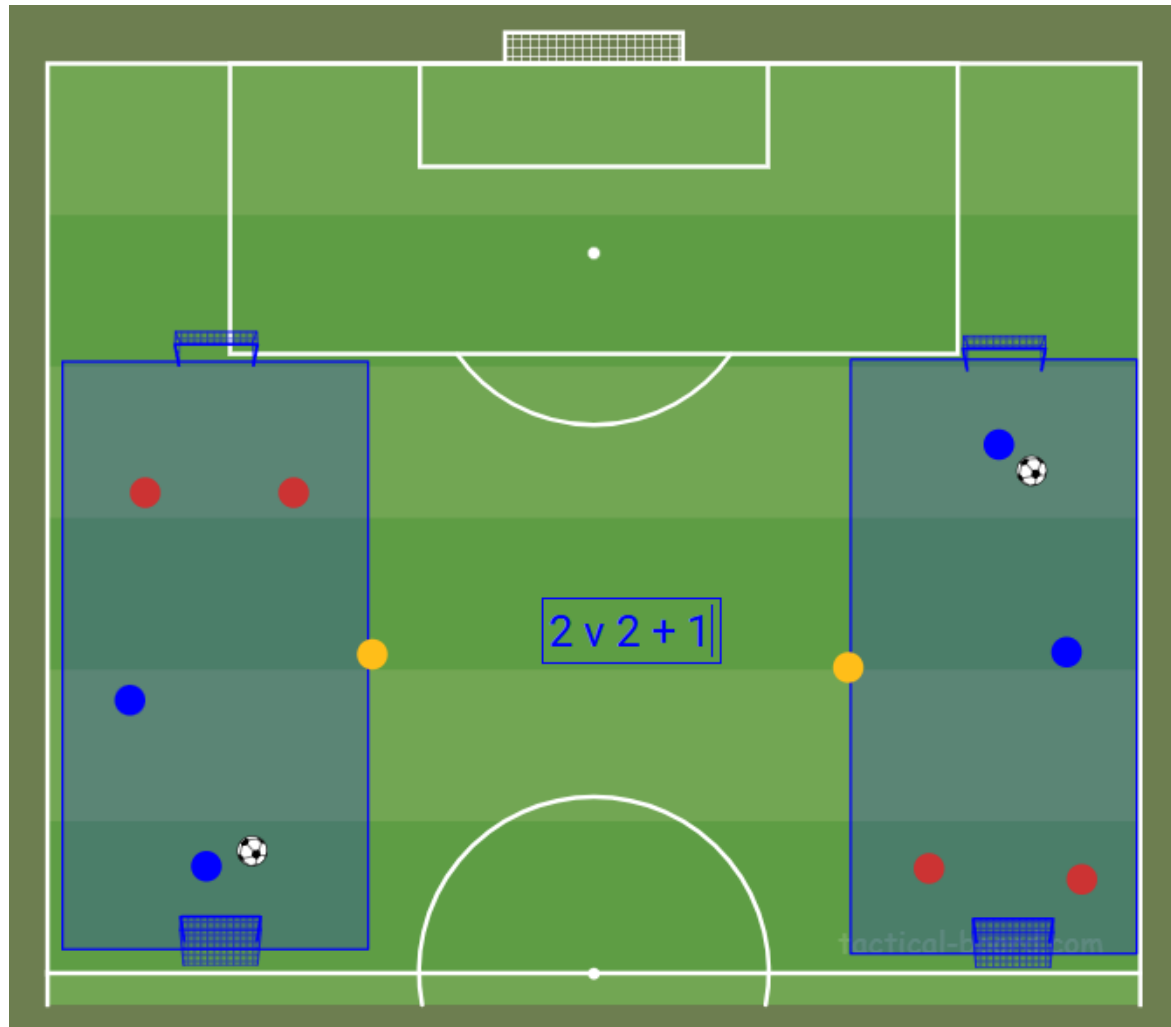
Objective

To encourage full-backs to **progress the ball forward through dribbling and combination play** in wide areas under game-like conditions.

Organization

- Players:
 - 2v2 in each wide channel
 - +1 neutral player (support player)
- Area:
 - Two wide channels on both flanks
- Equipment:
 - small goals

Diagram



Description

- The game is played as **2v2 + 1 neutral** in each wide channel.
- The objective is to score in the small goals positioned ahead.
- Players must progress forward through:
 - dribbling
 - combination play (e.g., wall passes)
- There is **no option to play backwards to a centre-back**, forcing players to find forward solutions.

Rules / Constraints

- Play is limited to the wide channel
- Neutral player supports the team in possession
- Goals can only be scored after progressing forward

Coaching Points

- 1v1 ability (beating opponent)
- timing of support
- combination play (one-two)
- decision making in tight spaces
- attacking mindset (forward thinking)

Why this exercise is used

This game forces full-backs to develop **forward-oriented behaviour** by removing backward passing options and encouraging progression through dribbling and combinations.

Parallel Practice (Central Players)

Description

- Central players perform a similar small-sided game in a central zone.
- Focus on:
 - quick combinations
 - playing in tight spaces
 - decision making under pressure

Final Game (End of Session)

Title

Conditioned Game (Half Pitch)

Description

- Teams play a game on half pitch with full goals.

Constraints

- Centre-backs: **1 touch only**
- Other players: **2 touches**
- Full-backs: **no touch limitation**

Objective

To encourage the team to:

- involve full-backs in build-up
- create forward progression through wide areas

Why this is important

This constraint naturally pushes the ball towards full-backs and reinforces their role in progressing the play.

Recording Setup

The training sessions are recorded using a camera placed in a central and elevated position to provide a full tactical view of the pitch. This allows the coaching staff to analyze team structure, player positioning, and decision-making.

The video footage is used for both staff and player analysis. Coaches review the positioning and decision-making of full-backs, while selected clips are shown to players to provide clear visual feedback, including both positive examples and situations for improvement.